

GOD'S PROMISES

KELVIN MARTIN

PART TWO

Continued from the August 2025 issue.

Man's Responsibility: *"If ye love me, keep my commandments"* (John 14:15). **God's Promises:** *"And I will pray the Father, and he shall give you another Comforter, that he may abide with you for ever; even the Spirit of truth; whom the world cannot receive, because it seeth him not, neither knoweth him: but ye know him; for he dwelleth with you, and shall be in you. I will not leave you comfortless: I will come to you"* (John 14:16–18).

Verse 16 speaks of the promise of the abiding Holy Spirit as "for ever" with His people. In the same context, God promised to Abraham that His covenant with His descendants would be everlasting. Verse 17 affirms that "ye know him." We have been taught through His Word and through prophecy that we need to know the still small voice of His Spirit. We have been filled with the Holy Spirit, but do we know Him?

God's Faithful Fulfillment Of His Promises: This promise of the indwelling of the Holy Spirit is fulfilled in Acts chapter 2. *"And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind, and it filled all the house where they were sitting. And there appeared unto them cloven tongues like as of fire, and it sat upon each of them. And they were all filled with the Holy Ghost, and began to speak with other tongues, as the Spirit gave them utterance"* (Acts 2:1–4).

Man's Responsibility: To get to know Him. This fulfillment will cause us to walk that perfect walk—that unimpaired walk of integrity with His Holy Spirit.

Old Testament type—the tabernacle in the wilderness—the dwelling place of God *amongst* His people. New Testament fulfillment—God's Holy Spirit dwelling *in* His people. The temple of the living God.

Our walk has been established through the Word. James speaks of the necessity of doing those things instructed to us by the Word (for context, please read James 1:16–22).

God's Faithful Fulfillment of His Promises: *"Of his own will begat he us with the word of truth ..."* (James 1:18) (remember Genesis 1:26–27). He made us in His own image.

God's Promises: *"that we should be a kind of firstfruits of his creatures"* (James 1:18).

Man's Responsibility: *"Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath: for the wrath of man worketh not the righteousness of God. Wherefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls. But be ye doers of the word, and not hearers only, deceiving your own selves"* (James 1:19–22).

Old Testament type – obedience to the Law. New Testament fulfillment – submission to the Word by the leading of the indwelling Spirit.

Christ speaks of His spiritual bloodline that comes only by being born again. *"There was a man of the Pharisees, named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews: the same came to Jesus by night, and said unto him, Rabbi, we know that thou art a teacher come from God:*

for no man can do these miracles that thou doest, except God be with him. Jesus answered and said unto him, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born again, he cannot see the kingdom of God. Nicodemus saith unto him, How can a man be born when he is old? can he enter the second time into his mother's womb, and be born?" (John 3:1-4)

Nicodemus, thinking with his natural mind, could not get his head around how someone could be born again, yet Christ said that it is a requirement to enter the kingdom of God. *"Jesus answered, Verily, verily, I say unto thee, Except a man be born of water and of the Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God. That which is born of the flesh is flesh; and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit. Marvel not that I said unto thee, Ye must be born again"* (John 3:5-7).

The promise of everlasting life is given to this "bloodline," those who are born again of Christ the testator (see Hebrews chapter 9) of a new and better covenant. It no longer requires DNA, as through Abraham, but rather by being filled and led by the Holy Spirit and entering into the spiritual realm through Jesus Christ.

Peter speaks of the life of holiness for those who are born again, into the family of God (spiritual "seed" not fleshly "seed") (for context, please read 1 Peter 1:15-23).

Man's Responsibility: *"But as he which hath called you is holy; so be ye holy in all manner of conversation; (manner of life, manner of conduct, manner of behaviour—not just what is spoken); Because it is written, Be ye holy; for I am holy. ... 22 Seeing ye have purified your souls in obeying the truth through the Spirit unto unfeigned love of the brethren, see that ye love one another with a pure heart fervently:"* (1 Peter 1:15-16 and 22).

This is the unimpaired, unencumbered walk he has called us to. Anything short of unfeigned (meaning genuine, sincere) love is impaired.

God's Faithful Fulfillment Of His Promises: *"Being born again, not of corruptible seed, but of incorruptible, by the word of God, which liveth and abideth for ever"* (1 Peter 1:23). God's fulfillment, our inheritance, is forever and for eternity. Do not sell your inheritance for a bowl of pottage (see Genesis 25:27-34). Therefore, as believers, God's plan involves you and me.

God's Promises: *"And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness: ..."* (Genesis 1:26). Who was this conversation with? Christ and the Holy Spirit. I see this as the same promise as **I will be their Father and they shall be my sons and daughters.**

Man's Responsibility: *"and let them have dominion (prevail against, reign, bear rule) over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth"* (Genesis 1:26).

God's Faithful Fulfillment of His Promises: *"So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them"* (Genesis 1:27).

Isaiah, a prophet of God, speaks of God's omnipotence and authority. God speaks of things to come concerning God's sons. *"Woe unto him that saith unto his father, What begettest thou? or to the woman, What hast thou brought forth? Thus saith the LORD, the Holy One of Israel, and his Maker, Ask me of things to come concerning my sons, and concerning the work of my hands command ye me. I have made the earth, and created man upon*

it: I, even my hands, have stretched out the heavens, and all their host have I commanded. I have raised him up in righteousness, and I will direct all his ways: he shall build my city, and he shall let go my captives, not for price nor reward, saith the LORD of hosts" (Isaiah 45:10-13).

God speaks through Isaiah of ancient things that have not yet been done or fulfilled. *"Remember this, and shew yourselves men: bring it again to mind, O ye transgressors. Remember the former things of old: for I am God, and there is none else; I am God, and there is none like me, Declaring the end from the beginning, and from ancient times the things that are not yet done, saying, My counsel shall stand, and I will do all my pleasure"* (Isaiah 46:8-10).

I believe Genesis 1:27 is prophetic. Has mankind ever lived in a world where we were in God's image? Adam and Eve, in their innocence, never reached the maturity that Genesis 1:27 speaks of. I think it is obvious that at no time in mankind's history have we fulfilled our responsibility of a perfect walk in God's/Christ's own image. How do we know that this has not yet been fulfilled?

Have we exercised the scriptural responsibility of *"have(ing) dominion over the fish of the sea, and over the fowl of the air, and over the cattle, and over all the earth, and over every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth"* (Genesis 1:26)?

Paul says we haven't. *"The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit, that we are the children of God: And if children, then heirs; heirs of God, and joint-heirs with Christ; if so be that we suffer with him, that we may be also glorified together. For I reckon that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which shall be revealed in us. ('by us' as in 2 Corinthians 1:20) For the earnest expectation of the creature waiteth for the manifestation of the sons of God. For the creature was made subject to vanity, not willingly, but by reason of him who hath subjected the same in hope, Because the creature itself also shall be delivered from the bondage of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of God. For we know that the whole creation groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now. And not only they, but ourselves also, which have the firstfruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting for the adoption, to wit, the redemption of our body"* (Romans 8:16-23).

Paul speaks of this dominion and reigning as the manifestation of the sons of God to the restoration of God's purpose and vision until God's creation gets to the point of *"And God saw every thing that he had made, and, behold, it was very good. ..."* (Genesis 1:31). The whole of creation waits expectantly for the manifestation of the sons of God. How are the sons of God defined? As in Genesis 1:26-27, in the image of God, Christ and the Holy Spirit and His sons are led by the Spirit. *"For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, they are the sons of God"* (Romans 8:14).

We have not yet fulfilled this level of maturity, but this is a promise that God has promised in His Word, and His Word will not come back to Him void as His Word will be fulfilled. Creation's hope is linked with our hope. Though we are filled with the Spirit (firstfruits), we have not reached that perfect walk of complete and unimpaired yielding to the leading of the Spirit. God's sons and daughters have not yet prevailed against the powers of the world and inherited their rightful place of ruling and reigning, with spiritual power and authority, with Christ as our head.

Christ is the firstborn, the eldest brother, of many brethren. They are predestined from the beginning, that those who are

called according to His purpose and filled with the Spirit will be conformed to the image of Christ. *“And we know that all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to his purpose. For whom he did foreknow, he also did predestinate to be conformed to the image of his Son, (see Genesis 1:26–27) that he (Christ) might be the firstborn among many brethren. Moreover whom he did predestinate, them he also called: and whom he called, them he also justified: and whom he justified, them he also glorified. What shall we then say to these things? If God be for us, who can be against us?”* (Romans 8:28–31).

Paul speaks to the Church in Ephesus, of the power of the Spirit that is given to us who believe that comes from heavenly places where Christ has been raised up into, to be the Head over all things to the Church, the body of Christ. I, Paul: *“Cease not to give thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers; That the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give unto you the spirit of wisdom and revelation in the knowledge of him: The eyes of your understanding being enlightened; that ye may know what is the hope of his calling, and what the riches of the glory of his inheritance in the saints, And what is the exceeding greatness of his power to us-ward who believe, according to the working of his mighty power, Which he wrought in Christ, when he raised him from the dead, and set him at his own right hand in the heavenly places, Far above all principality, and power, and might, and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this world, but also in that which is to come: And hath put all things under his feet, and gave him to be the head over all things to the church, Which is his body, the fulness of him that filleth all in all”* (Ephesians 1:16-23).

For context, please read 2 Corinthians 6:1–18 in its entirety. Paul instructs very clearly about our walk, according to the calling placed on our earthly lives. *“We then, as workers together with him, (Christ), beseech you also that ye receive not the grace of God in vain”* (2 Corinthians 6:1).

It has been ministered by the brethren that we can easily envision how Christ laboured with His Heavenly Father. However, we have a hard time envisioning how we can labour with Christ. Why? Because we focus on our failings! We don't focus on His promises! As we have discussed, the Old Testament speaks of God never forsaking Israel, regardless of their failures, because His covenant was one way. God always makes a way for the restoration of His people. They just had to stop doubting His promises to them. God had shown them that He had the power and love to fulfill them.

How much greater than, through Christ's death on the cross, is the power of His resurrection, and Christ as the testator of a better covenant (Hebrews 9). God's Word promises that He will never forsake His sons and daughters. *“Let your conversation be without covetousness; and be content with such things as ye have: for he hath said, I will never leave thee, nor forsake thee”* (Hebrews 13:5, Joshua 1:5, Psalms 37:25, 2 Corinthians 4:9–10).

“Be ye not unequally yoked together with unbelievers: for what fellowship hath righteousness with unrighteousness? and what communion hath light with darkness” (2 Corinthians 6:14) Also see John 1:5.

The Old Testament type of being unequally yoked is found in the time of Noah (for context, please read Genesis 6:1–5). Where was the unequal yoke? The sons of God, incorruptible seed, and the daughters of men, corruptible seed. “That the sons of God saw the

daughters of men that they were fair; and they took them wives of all which they chose” (Genesis 6:2).

Continuing in 2 Corinthians: *“And what concord hath Christ with Belial? or what part hath he that believeth with an infidel? And what agreement hath the temple of God with idols? for ye are the temple of the living God; as God hath said, I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God, and they shall be my people”* (2 Corinthians 6:15–16). Also see Leviticus 26:12.

Paul continues writing through, what I believe to be, the gift of prophecy. Notice the words and phraseology: *“Wherefore come out from among them, and be ye separate (set apart for a purpose, sanctified), saith the Lord, and touch not the unclean thing; and I will receive you, And will be a Father unto you, and ye shall be my sons and daughters, saith the Lord Almighty”* (2 Corinthians 6:17–18).

When Paul spoke prophetically, what did he speak? The Word of God! God gave him these words to say. They are as true as if God said them Himself. When you enter into the Spirit of prophecy, by the Spirit, this same fact is true and His Word will not return to Him void. It will be fulfilled. What a vision. What a promise. Let us remember and believe Paul in his encouragement to the believers in Philippi: *“Being confident of this very thing, that he which hath begun a good work in you will perform it until the day of Jesus Christ”* (Philippians 1:6).

His Word will be fulfilled. **I will be a Father unto you, and ye shall be my sons and daughters.**

I would like to conclude with John's vision from God as recorded in the Book of Revelation. In Revelation chapters 2 and 3, John recorded what God was saying to the seven churches. There is a shared phrase used to each of the churches that includes wording to the effect of *“he/him that overcometh.”*

The word *overcometh* in our modern vocabulary sometimes gives an image of a task that has to be endured, or of being overpowered or incapacitated (like enduring another long sermon). In looking up the meaning of *overcometh*, translated from the Greek word *nikaō*, it means one who is victorious. The feeling of enduring, although in a sense a long process, is swallowed up by the wonderful elation of victory.

I pray that the Spirit of the Lord fills your heart with joy and hope with this vision. We have been assured that the battle is the Lord's and we will be victorious through Christ.

- **The Church of Ephesus:** *“He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the tree of life, which is in the midst of the paradise of God”* (Revelation 2:7).
- **The Church in Smyrna:** *“He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; He that overcometh shall not be hurt of the second death”* (Revelation 2:11).
- **The Church in Pergamos:** *“He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, and will give him a white stone, and in the stone a new name written, which no man knoweth saving he that receiveth it”* (Revelation 2:17).
- **The Church in Thyatira:** *“And he that overcometh, and*

keepeth my works unto the end, to him will I give power over the nations: And he shall rule them with a rod of iron; as the vessels of a potter shall they be broken to shivers: even as I received of my Father. And I will give him the morning star. He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches” (Revelation 2: 26-29).

- **The Church in Sardis:** *“He that overcometh, the same shall be clothed in white raiment; and I will not blot out his name out of the book of life, but I will confess his name before my Father, and before his angels. He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches” (Revelation 3:5-6).*
- **The Church in Philadelphia:** *“Him that overcometh will I make a pillar in the temple of my God, and he shall go no more out: and I will write upon him the name of my God, and the name of the city of my God, which is new Jerusalem, which cometh down out of heaven from my God: and I will write upon him my new name. He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches” (Revelation 3:12-13).*
- **The Church of the Laodiceans:** *“To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with me in my throne, even as I also overcame, and am set down with my Father in his throne. He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches” (Revelation 3:21-22).*

But Finally, to God’s Sons and Daughters, the Church, the Body of Christ, the Bride of Christ *“And I saw a new heaven and a new earth: for the first heaven and the first earth were passed away; and there was no more sea. And I John saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband. And I heard a great voice out of heaven saying, Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and he will dwell with them, and they shall be his people, and God himself shall be with them, and be their God. And God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes (promise); and there shall be no more death (promise), neither sorrow (promise), nor crying (promise), neither shall there be any more pain (promise): for the former things are passed away” (Revelation 21:1-4).*

Do we believe that His promises will be fulfilled? Because until we believe in His faithfulness to fulfill, we can’t enter into the fullness of His promises. If we keep allowing doubt to fill our hearts and minds, then we will continue to wander through the wilderness, inhibiting our entering into the fullness of His promises.

“And he that sat upon the throne said, Behold, I make all things new. And he said unto me, Write: for these words are true and faithful (i.e., He is faithful to fulfill His words). And he said unto me, It is done. I am Alpha and Omega, the beginning and the end. I will give unto him that is athirst of the fountain of the water of life freely. He that overcometh shall inherit all things; and I will be his God (Heavenly Father), and he shall be my son (and daughter)” (Revelation 21:5-7).

We are not there yet. If God says it will be done, there is a time, there is a day—that time of Jesus Christ (see Philippians 1:6)—that will come. I pray that we believe that God is able to fulfill His promises through us, be manifested by us, and that we will give all the glory to God.

Fulfilling the Word *“And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness:... So God created man in his own image, in the image of God created he him; male and female created he them” (Genesis 1:26-27).*

This magnificent vision that John saw will be fulfilled because His sons and daughters will have chosen to walk unencumbered, unimpaired, and with full integrity, by the leading of the Spirit.

This article has presented many promises by God’s Word, and I pray that we believe He will be faithful to fulfill each and every one. However, I want to emphasize one specific promise: **I will be their God, and they will be my people**—as recorded in the Old Testament with regard to the descendants of Abraham—but even more so: **I will be their Heavenly Father, and they shall be my sons and daughters**—in the New Testament with regard to the body of Christ, the Church. ✚

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Headquarters:
802 Airport Road
North Battleford, SK S9A 2Z3 Canada

Mailing Address:
P.O. Box 934
North Battleford, SK S9A 2Z3 Canada

Telephone:
(306) 445-2733

Email:
info@globalmissionsinc.org

Online:
www.globalmissionsinc.org

Traveling Ministry Contact List:
www.globalmissionsinc.org/about

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